Q+A

THE SOULFUL SINGER

With a song on the soundtrack of the controversial blockbuster *Animal* and top billing on Spotify, the shy **Arijit Singh** is enjoying the spotlight



Q. You are officially the most streamed singer in India on Spotify, for the fourth consecutive year. How does it feel?
It has been a long journey where I have learnt and grown so much. I am grateful for the appreciation, recognition, awards and love that motivate me all the time to make the next song even bigger and better!

Q. How was the experience of recording 'Satranga' for the *Animal* soundtrack?
'Satranga' is very close to my heart. The moment Shreyas Puranik sent me a scratch recording of how he wanted the song sung, I was impressed. In fact, I told him he can sing it himself. The idea was not to outdo him, but to add to his vision. I'm grateful he trusted me with it.

Q. Why do you hardly give interviews?
I am generally not someone who talks much. I'm an introvert. Despite being grateful for the love I get from people, I do not like fame. The other day someone told me I should have been a singer in the era of Radio Ceylon! I would have been so happy with it—to be heard, and not seen!

Q. What sort of music would you like to do in future?
I'm grateful that I'm doing independent music as well as commercial Bollywood. I want to try more classical and even folk music from across India. I'd be happier if my classical songs, folk renditions and cultural explorations earned top spots on streaming channels too.

with Aarti Kapur Singh

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